Roam Alone

Game Design Document

Working title • Version 0.4 • 27 October 2026

Purpose and immediate direction

Build a small, convincing psychological horror experience about the vulnerability of traveling alone in a camper van. Beautiful daytime exploration establishes freedom and comfort; nighttime disturbances turn that same familiar space into a place the player must actively protect.

The immediate production goal is one van, one campsite, one playable night and one compelling horror event. This document turns that goal into a testable prototype plan while keeping later episodes conditional on what the first night proves.

Project context

Project location: D:\unrealProjects\RoamAlone
Engine target: Unreal Engine 5.8.4, as supplied by the developer
Development model: solo developer using C++, Blueprints, Rider, Codex and Unreal MCP

How to read this document

CONFIRMED identifies concepts explicitly supplied in the current brief. PROPOSED identifies recommendations introduced here for review or prototyping. OPEN identifies decisions that remain unresolved. A proposal is not an approved production commitment.

This revision records the current campsite encounter direction. CONFIRMED describes the requested experience; PROPOSED describes a prototype approach or candidate cue. Design entries do not by themselves claim that gameplay, assets or packaged validation are complete.

Document map

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2–3	Vision, scope, core loop and controls
4–7	Systems, first night, routines, cues and campsite design
8–11	Art, audio, accessibility and encounter authoring
12–14	MVP acceptance, milestones, risks and decision log

Next prototype: one ordinary outdoor task, a readable reason to retreat, and a nighttime disturbance whose response uses the actual van door state. Prove this small sequence before adding more chores or scares.

Vision and scope

Experience vision

CONFIRMED — The player is a female solo van-life vlogger traveling among campsites in the United States. The game combines scenic days with increasingly threatening nights. Isolation, uncertain intent and the fragile privacy of a camper support the psychological horror premise.

Design pillars

• Freedom becomes vulnerability. Let the player enjoy the view and learn the campsite before darkness makes distance, sightlines and exposure matter.

• The van is an active refuge. Free interior movement, a visible body, contextual interactions and manual locks make safety feel physical and deliberate.

• Fear comes from readable uncertainty. Footsteps, knocks, vehicles and possible intruders should provoke decisions without revealing every cause.

• Small spaces carry authored tension. Reuse a well-understood van and build distinct campsite episodes instead of expanding into an open world.

PROPOSED evaluation rule — Every prototype feature must improve orientation, vulnerability, agency or recovery. If it does none of these, defer it.

Scope boundaries

Area	Confirmed direction	Prototype boundary proposed
World	Episodic campsites and nights	One compact campsite with a short outdoor route
Travel	Brief cinematic simulates travel	A transition or simple arrival shot; no vehicle physics
Character	Female protagonist; Quinn placeholder	Quinn proves mechanics; final character and animation deferred
Threat	Disturbances and possible intrusion	One authored event; no general enemy simulation
Needs	Occasional reasons to risk going outside	One ordinary outdoor task; water or bathroom outings deferred
Weather	Ultra Dynamic Sky and Weather direction	One controlled day to night preset after compatibility check

Decisions deliberately left open

Final title, release platforms, total episode count, game length, combat, death rules, threat identity and whether events have supernatural causes are unresolved. No multiplayer, crafting, hunger economy, procedural world or extensive driving is required for the prototype.

Core loop and player control

The episode loop

CONFIRMED structure — Arrive at a campsite, experience its scenic daytime identity, prepare the camper, endure escalating nighttime disturbances, then transition onward through a short travel cinematic.

CONFIRMED encounter direction — Perform an ordinary campsite task outdoors during day or evening → notice increasingly unsettling cues → receive a reason to retreat → enter the van at night → choose whether to close and lock up → experience a disturbance that responds to the actual door state → reach a clear resolution.

The player should make spatial and timing decisions, not manage a large inventory. Vlogging establishes motivation and mood; it need not become a separate scoring or editing system.

Perspective and movement

CONFIRMED — Outdoor play uses third person. The camper interior uses immersive first person with a visible body, free movement and contextual interaction. The player is not anchored to a seat or a fixed camera inside.

PROPOSED — Use a threshold volume with a short camera blend and transition hysteresis to avoid rapid toggling at the doorway. Preserve facing and input continuity. Block neither the doorway nor the player's view during the blend. Interior body visibility may use selective mesh hiding near the camera while retaining legs and torso where practical.

Provisional input map

Action	Keyboard and mouse proposal	Behavior
Move and look	WASD and mouse	Same movement intention across both perspectives
Interact	E	Context action such as opening a door or using a tap
Lock or unlock	E when aiming at the inside lock	Separate contextual lock target; use the same interaction action
Light	F	Toggle a handheld light if included in the MVP
Move faster	Shift	Optional; speed and stamina rules remain open
Pause	Esc	Settings, restart checkpoint and quit

OPEN — Controller mappings, crouch, sprint, camera shoulder, object inspection and whether the player can change view manually. Keep these out of the first build unless a playtest demonstrates a need.

Interaction contract proposed

A prompt states the action and target. A locked handle produces a clear response. A close command does not silently lock the door. Only show interactions in range and unobstructed; prioritize the lock when the player aims at the lock itself.

Gameplay systems

Doors and the camper boundary

CONFIRMED — Doors can be locked manually only while closed. Closing does not automatically lock. A locked door refuses opening; an inside unlock action remains available without a key or resource. The encounter must observe the existing door owner and preserve these rules.

Represent the handle, lock, animation and sound as views of the same authoritative state. A failed open attempt on a locked door plays restrained feedback and changes nothing. Prototype intrusion occurs through an unlocked door or an authored external disturbance; any forced breach rule requires a separate design decision.

Needs as occasional story tasks

CONFIRMED — Gather three individual logs at fixed locations around the campsite, then deliver all three to the fire pit once. Collection keeps the player outside and gives later authored cues a place in the route. Fire preparation and cooking remain later candidates. Avoid survival meters, broad inventories and crafting systems.

Let the player hesitate long enough to listen and plan. If waiting must eventually advance the sequence, define a clear fallback beat. Do not punish an accessibility setting or slower navigation with an invisible deadline.

Disturbance and event system proposed

System	Minimum behavior	Deferral
Sound cues	Bounded ambient cues plus explicit critical footsteps and knocks	Acoustic simulation of every actor
Event sequence	One placed director; prerequisites, phase and one-shot flags	General purpose procedural horror director
Threat representation	Offscreen source or short controlled silhouette	Patrol, search and combat AI
Objective state	One current objective and task completion flags	Quest tree or branching journal
Checkpoint	Deterministic development reset first; checkpoint remains proposed	Save anywhere and cross episode persistence

Failure and recovery

OPEN — The exact unlocked-door consequence and recovery. A brief door opening with an alarming cue and an opportunity to respond is PROPOSED for evaluation. Death, capture, chase, forced intrusion and checkpoint restart are not approved by this revision. Define a readable consequence before implementing it; a locked door must not be silently bypassed.

Acceptance focus: the player understands what changed and can retry without replaying a long opening. Reloading restores doors, lighting, objective and event progression together.

Horror pacing and the first night

CONFIRMED direction — Daytime or evening routine builds unease before a nighttime retreat into the van. The sequence below is a PROPOSED first playable slice. Use explicit prerequisites and one-shot events; individual sounds, figure placement, delays and the resolution remain tuning choices.

Beat	Player experience	Trigger and implementation
Daylight routine	Learn the campsite while doing a normal task	Gather three scattered logs, then place all three at the fire pit in one delivery
Outdoor unease	A small sound interrupts concentration	One authored branch snap after task progress; leave a quiet interval
Possible presence	A distant figure creates uncertainty	Optional later cue; remove after a verified look-away, never pop into a watched empty space
Reason to retreat	The outside feels less comfortable as evening fades	One nearby disturbance; objective clearly points back to the van
Shelter and preparation	Enter at night and decide whether to lock up	Task resolved and player inside at night; allow time to close and lock without automatic locking
Boundary test	Footsteps stop, knocks follow, then the handle is tried	One authored sequence after a quiet delay; evaluate current door state at the attempt
Consequence	Preparation changes the response	Locked: door holds and visitor withdraws. Unlocked or open: distinct consequence remains OPEN
Resolution	The first encounter ends clearly and can restart	Proposed quiet withdrawal or morning beat; reset every phase and cue

Why this event is worth testing

An ordinary task gives the player a focus while the campsite becomes less comfortable. Returning changes the van from a familiar object into an active refuge. The handle attempt makes closing and locking observable decisions. Keep the visitor’s identity and the cause of the disturbance unresolved.

Pacing rules proposed

• Establish at least one ordinary example of a sound or object before making it suspicious. Keep most time quiet enough for the player to notice change.

• Escalate from distant presence to proximity to boundary testing. Avoid repeated full-volume surprises that make every cue feel equivalent.

• Never spawn the threat in an obviously observed empty space. Gate a silhouette on player sightline, or keep the event offscreen.

• After a major beat, allow a recovery interval. Use a development reset button and event log so timing changes remain easy to test.

Campsite routines and disturbance cues

Ordinary tasks establish the baseline

CONFIRMED direction — The player spends day or evening outside doing ordinary campsite activities while unease grows. Firewood collection, preparing a fire and cooking food are candidate activities. They are not a requirement to build three interconnected systems in the first prototype.

CONFIRMED first task — Gather three individual logs along a short campsite route. Show Collect firewood: 0/3 and update after each unique pickup. Carry all three and place them together at the fire pit. Refuse early placement without losing progress. Reset restores every log and the empty pit. No inventory screen or new carry animation is required.

Outdoor cues during day and evening

PROPOSED — Start with one spatial branch snap or movement sound while the player is occupied. Let silence follow. A later nearby sound can give a readable reason to return to the van as evening darkens. Avoid repeatedly interrupting the task or silently timing out a slower player.

PROPOSED candidate cue — Stage a distant figure at a controlled sightline. Once seen, remove it only after the player looks away; a second look finds the space empty. Do not spawn or disappear in an obviously watched location. Define visibility checks and a reset before using this cue; the figure needs no patrol or combat AI.

Nighttime cues around the van

CONFIRMED direction — Once the player is sheltering inside at night, sounds outside test the feeling of safety. Footsteps around the van and knocks support the first boundary test. Whispers and laughter are candidate later cues, not a continuous layer or a mandatory set in every run.

PROPOSED candidate cue — Suggest a vehicle with two headlights and engine audio. A short authored path approaches the van, stops with the lights on it, then reverses or withdraws and drives off. Use one Blueprint presentation actor and a Timeline or short sequence; a modeled car, real driving and vehicle physics are unnecessary.

Use cues selectively

Give each cue a purpose and a recovery interval. First prove one outdoor sound and the night boundary test. Add the figure or headlights one at a time if they improve the player’s understanding or tension. Keep normal ambience quiet enough for important sounds and their captions to remain readable.

Narrative and campsite design

Narrative foundation

CONFIRMED — The protagonist is a woman documenting solo van life. Travel supplies episodic structure; daytime beauty and nighttime danger create the central emotional contrast. Her name, age, background, audience, route and reasons for traveling remain OPEN.

PROPOSED — Use short vlog introductions and private reactions to contrast the trip she presents publicly with the fear she experiences alone. Keep essential objectives understandable without watching a video. Environmental changes and restrained dialogue should carry more of the prototype than exposition.

OPEN — Whether a single pursuer links campsites, each episode has a distinct threat, or the player cannot reliably separate human danger from psychological interpretation. Test the first night without resolving the larger mystery or committing to an ending.

Vlog cutscenes

CONFIRMED possibility — AI-generated vlog footage may be used. PROPOSED — Test a short nonessential clip only after the core loop works. Use a placeholder image, text card or in-engine shot first. Evaluate continuity of face, voice, clothing and van, plus usage rights and revision effort. An AI video pipeline is not required to validate gameplay.

One campsite graybox

PROPOSED layout — Place the van and fire in a clearing, three spaced firewood pickups, a recognizable return landmark, distant figure staging and a hidden road approach for headlights. Keep one readable outdoor route. Reserve water or bathroom locations for a later task only if the first encounter earns the added scope.

• Day route: reveal the destination and a recognizable return landmark before night. Avoid navigation difficulty masquerading as fear.

• Van interior: fit a usable aisle, sleeping area and the interactable door. Test body collision and camera clearance before adding clutter.

• Night route: shape a few sightlines and one exposed segment. Preserve a readable van silhouette or landmark without lighting the entire scene.

• Event staging: reserve sound anchors around the van and a hidden light approach. Keep the firewood task and return route accessible when the door is open, closed or locked. Avoid placing essential controls where a moving panel hides them.

Episode expansion rule proposed

A later campsite should change one spatial pressure and one horror idea while reusing the van and foundational systems. Do not build the next episode until the first can be completed, understood and reset reliably.

Art audio and atmosphere

Visual direction

CONFIRMED — Scenic days should be beautiful; nights should become increasingly threatening. Ultra Dynamic Sky and Weather are the chosen atmosphere tools. Quinn is the confirmed female prototype character. Final character design and asset style remain OPEN.

PROPOSED — Use a grounded contemporary van and campsite with restrained environmental detail. Build a believable personal refuge through a few meaningful objects rather than dense clutter. Daylight should establish the same landmarks that become ambiguous at night.

Lighting and weather plan proposed

• Begin with one clear daytime state, one dusk transition and one night state. Lock time and weather at key horror beats so their readability is repeatable.

• Create a temporary lighting fallback before plugin integration. Verify the installed sky and weather versions against the actual project before depending on their APIs or packaging behavior.

• Keep the interior readable through practical lamps and reflected light. Tune exposure so looking out of the van does not erase necessary cues or make the interior unusable.

• Rain and wind can mask sounds in later tests, but add no weather-dependent puzzle or systemic forecast to the MVP.

Sound hierarchy

Layer	Purpose	Prototype asset budget proposed
Day ambience	Sell a pleasant place and normal activity	One loop plus a few distinct local sounds
Night ambience	Leave room for threat cues	One quieter loop with controllable wind
Van feedback	Confirm interaction and safety state	Door open, close, lock, unlock and handle rattle
Threat cues	Communicate direction and proximity	Footsteps and knocks first; whispers, laughter, figure and headlights are candidate additions
Music	Shape key transitions sparingly	Optional short texture; no continuous score needed

Production priorities

Spend polish first on the door interaction, sound placement, night visibility and the van threshold. A small coherent set of placeholders is sufficient elsewhere. Record asset sources and licenses as assets enter the project. Final voice acting, a detailed protagonist and bespoke cinematics are later production choices.

PROPOSED audio rule — A critical cue must remain understandable at comfortable volume. Build tension with timing and location, not painful loudness.

User experience and accessibility

Interface direction proposed

Keep play readable with a small contextual prompt and a brief current objective. Show lock feedback at the door through animation, sound and concise text. Do not display an omniscient threat indicator that resolves the mystery. A short objective reminder should help a player who returns after a break.

Use a pause menu with resume, settings, restart checkpoint and quit. On restart, clearly identify the checkpoint. The opening tutorial should cover movement, the perspective transition and one close then lock sequence inside normal play.

Prototype accessibility baseline proposed

Need	Implementation target	Verification
Motion comfort	Separate look sensitivity; camera shake off; reduced head motion; configurable blend	Walk through the threshold repeatedly without forced sway
Readable interaction	Scalable text, high contrast prompts and generous target range	Read prompts against both daylight and dark interior
Hearing access	Captions for speech and meaningful sounds; optional directional labels	Complete the event with sound muted
Input access	Rebind actions; avoid rapid tapping and long mandatory holds	Complete close, lock and the outdoor task using alternate bindings
Volume control	Separate master, ambience, effects and dialogue controls	Critical cues remain usable with reduced volume
Pacing access	Pause during active play; avoid hidden urgency on the outdoor task	Pause and resume at each event stage

Preserving uncertainty accessibly

Caption what is perceptible, such as “Footsteps outside, left,” rather than naming a stalker or giving an exact location. If a directional caption would reveal more than the sound, broaden it. Communicate an important visual-only cue through an equivalent sound or caption.

Comfort and failure

PROPOSED — Offer a concise content notice for stalking, intrusion and sudden scares, updated when content is finalized. Make cutscenes skippable with essential information restated in play. Keep any first-person field of view and body animation comfortable in the small interior.

OPEN — Final controller support, difficulty settings, reduced scare mode, localization languages and subtitle speaker identification. Target hardware and release platforms must be chosen before setting performance and certification requirements.

Technical architecture and workflow

CONFIRMED — Use C++ for foundational systems and Blueprints for iteration, with Rider, Codex and Unreal MCP in the workflow. The names below are proposed responsibilities, not claims about classes already present in the project.

Foundation proposed in C++	Iteration proposed in Blueprints or data
Player locomotion and perspective state	Camera blend tuning, animation selection and threshold placement
Interaction interface and target selection	Prompts, object responses, interaction sounds and effects
Door owner with validated open and lock operations	Van assembly, door movement, handle and lock presentation
Small night phase and event flags only where native logic is useful	Placed director, editable settings, cue presentation and authored timing
Objective flags and checkpoint snapshot	Objective wording, task presentation and checkpoint location
Settings and input action handling	UI presentation and comfort defaults

State and event flow proposed

Player requests interaction → target validates range and state → door or task state changes → sequence receives a completion signal → the next eligible beat starts. Presentation reacts to committed state. Avoid letting a sound, animation callback and UI prompt each maintain separate copies of lock state.

PROPOSED approach — One placed night director owns a short authored phase sequence. Keep cue references, delays and placements editable; use a small encounter settings asset only where shared configurations earn it. A few explicit settings are sufficient for the first encounter. Generalize after a second real sequence demonstrates reuse.

Persistence and debugging proposed

PROPOSED debugging — Provide a deterministic reset and a way to jump to the phase under test. Cancel timers, stop active audio, hide the figure, restore headlights and UDS presentation, and clear one-shot and objective flags. Restore door state through its validated operations. A checkpoint or save system remains a separate proposal, not a requirement for the first encounter.

Build and tool discipline

PROPOSED — Keep source control and a recoverable baseline before assisted edits. Use Codex for small reviewable changes and Unreal MCP for supported editor tasks after confirming the connected project. Verify results in the editor and a packaged build; do not treat a successful tool call as gameplay validation.

Engine 5.8.4 is the developer-supplied target. No engine release status, installed plugin compatibility or MCP setup is verified here. First milestone checks the actual project, C++ build, plugin loading and packaged launch. Avoid designing around unverified version-specific APIs.

Encounter authoring and state ownership

A small authored sequence with tunable data

PROPOSED — Begin with one placed night director and a short phase sequence: outdoor task, outdoor unease, retreat, shelter, boundary test and resolution. Keep stable validation in existing gameplay owners. Author the sequence and presentation in Blueprint unless native complexity or testing needs justify moving a specific part to C++.

Expose cue actor references, sound assets, delays, placements, objective text and a few timing ranges for tuning. A small encounter settings Data Asset is appropriate when repeated configurations make it useful. Do not create a generic quest editor, string-based function dispatcher, global event bus or procedural scare scheduler for one night.

Ownership and communication

The director owns phase, current objective and one-shot event flags. Task actors report meaningful completion through the existing interaction path. Cue actors own figure visibility, spatial sound or the headlight presentation. UI displays objective and feedback; it does not advance the encounter or store a second lock state.

The van remains the door and lock authority. At the handle attempt, query the live state rather than remembering whether it was locked on entry. A locked door holds. An unlocked closed door may open only through its validated operation and clearance checks. If the door is already open, use an explicit open-door response; never wait indefinitely for an impossible close or lock prerequisite.

Use the existing project-owned UDS integration for day, evening and night changes. One authority advances environmental time. The director requests a presentation change; critical events use phase prerequisites rather than exact clock equality. Keep UDS calls out of individual props and cues.

Dependable progression and restrained variation

Critical beats have explicit prerequisites and fire once. Begin the first inside disturbance after the outdoor objective is resolved, the player is inside at night and a quiet delay has elapsed. Leave an opportunity to prepare, but do not require a locked door to trigger the event. Support early return and subsequent task completion without losing progress.

Ambient cues may vary within small timing ranges, with cooldowns and overlap limits. Suspend or defer them during critical sounds. Repeated interaction must not duplicate a phase or restart a scare. Variation must never prevent completion; a deterministic development mode should reproduce the sequence.

Acceptance and unresolved behavior

Acceptance: complete the task and retreat; observe distinct locked and unlocked responses; freely unlock from inside; finish and reset twice without duplicate cues or stale timers. Check early return, waiting, an open door, a blocked opening and pausing. OPEN: the exact unlocked consequence, response opportunity and final resolution. Decide these before implementing dependent effects.

MVP backlog and acceptance

PROPOSED MVP — One complete first-night experience. A rough 10–15 minute test session is an initial pacing hypothesis, not a promised game length. It can be shorter if the interaction and horror idea are already proven.

Priority	Deliverable	Acceptance evidence
P0	Walkable campsite and camper	Player reaches the task and returns; no collision trap
P0	Third person outside and first person inside	Visible body; free interior movement; stable doorway transitions
P0	Manual door locking	Closing does not auto-lock; locked open attempts fail clearly
P0	One ordinary outdoor task	Task advances once; no survival meter or general crafting system
P0	One horror event	Routine, retreat and nighttime boundary test complete in order; door state changes the response
P0	Completion and recovery	Night reaches morning; reset restores the intended safe state
P0	Basic readable presentation	Critical sound captions, usable prompts and comfort controls
P1	Atmosphere integration	Chosen sky and weather state works in a packaged build
Later	Vlog video and travel polish	Only after the playable loop passes review

Functional verification checklist

• Complete both lock responses. Check the actual lock state at the handle attempt, allow inside unlocking, and verify that an already-open door does not stall the encounter. Do not force an invalid lock or bypass a locked door.

• Cross the van threshold slowly, quickly and backward. Check camera clipping, visible body, collision, prompt focus and control continuity.

• Return early, delay the task, wait inside, pause during a cue, and repeat the night. Confirm that ambient cues do not overlap critical beats, events fire once, and reset clears audio, figure visibility, lights, timers and objectives.

• Run from packaged launch through morning and restart. Check atmosphere, captions, settings and missing assets outside the editor.

Player test gate proposed

Observe a small first round of three fresh players. Ask what they believed the lock did, why they went outside and which moment made them feel unsafe. Proceed when players can finish without developer directions, understand their safety action and identify the intended event as a memorable threat. If navigation or prompts dominate their feedback, fix those before adding content.

Record completion, assistance needed, confusion and strongest fear moment. These are qualitative prototype signals; three players do not establish market demand or final accessibility coverage.

Milestones and production risks

PROPOSED plan — Advance by evidence, not calendar promises. Estimate dates after the first graybox and build check. Each milestone ends with a playable build and a short list of unresolved issues.

Gate	Work package	Exit condition
M0 Baseline	Open project, compile, check tools and assets	Correct engine and plugin versions recorded; packaged test launches
M1 Embodiment	Graybox, perspectives, interaction and doors	Van entry and manual locking feel clear and reliable
M2 First night	Outdoor task, authored cues and event branches	Full sequence completes and resets without state errors
M3 Atmosphere	Night lighting, spatial sound, captions and comfort	Core scene readable and threatening at comfortable settings
M4 Validation	Fresh player observation and packaged regression	MVP acceptance met; retain, revise or cut decisions recorded
M5 Expansion decision	Estimate next campsite and production asset needs	Approve a second episode only if reusable foundation is stable

Risk register

Risk	Mitigation and scope response
Interior camera and body clipping	Test aisle and threshold first; simplify animation before rebuilding the van
Horror feels scripted or unfair	Tie outcomes to readable actions; use silence and spatial cues; revise timing from observation
Feature growth overwhelms solo capacity	Keep one task and event; defer combat, driving and broad AI
Plugin or engine incompatibility	Verify early in a copy; retain a basic atmosphere fallback and known working build
Asset and AI media inconsistency	Use placeholders until validated; track licenses and continuity before production use
No target performance budget	Choose hardware before final assets; profile the packaged worst night scene

Cut order proposed

If the milestone slips, cut cooking, extra chores, additional cue types, vlog footage, travel polish and weather variation first. Preserve one outdoor task, a reason to retreat, manual locking and one complete disturbance with a clear resolution. Expand only after that loop is understandable and reliable.

Decision log and next actions

CONFIRMED rows record the requested experience. PROPOSED rows remain implementation or content choices to evaluate. OPEN rows require a decision before dependent behavior is built. The campsite routine and retreat direction supersedes the earlier proposed water-outing sequence.

ID	Status	Decision or question	Next evidence or action
D01	Confirmed	Female solo van-life vlogger in US campsites	Keep as the experience foundation
D02	Confirmed	Scenic days and escalating nights	Validate emotional contrast in one location
D03	Confirmed	Third person outdoors; embodied first person inside	Prove camera and collision in the graybox
D04	Confirmed	Manual locks and occasional outdoor needs	Build one door and one task first
D05	Confirmed	Episodic sites; cinematic travel	Defer driving and open world systems
D06	Confirmed	C++ foundation and Blueprint iteration	Record actual project and tool baseline at M0
D07	Confirmed	Outdoor routine, retreat and a lock-responsive night disturbance	Replaces proposed water-first sequence; prototype one small task
D08	Open	Unlocked-door consequence, failure and recovery	Decide before implementing; brief opening cue is a proposal
D09	Open	Threat identity and overarching story	Resolve after the first night establishes tone
D10	Open	Platform, hardware, episode count and duration	Set before full production estimates
D11	Open	Final character, vlog format and AI media use	Evaluate continuity, rights and production cost
D12	Proposed	One checkpoint and no survival economy	Retain unless playtests identify a concrete need
D13	Proposed	One placed director with editable cue settings	Prove first sequence; add data assets when reuse earns them
D14	Confirmed	Gather three scattered logs before one fire-pit delivery	Test exposure, pickup feedback, early returns and repeatable reset
D15	Proposed	Figure, whispers, laughter and two-light vehicle illusion	Evaluate cues separately; no full vehicle or general enemy AI

Next implementation slice

• Preserve the playable van baseline and verify interaction, door state, camera transitions and reset behavior.

• Playtest the three-log route and single fire-pit delivery. Check that pickup progress, early-return feedback and reset are clear; defer inventory and cooking systems.

• Author one quiet outdoor cue, a reason to retreat, and an inside nighttime boundary test. Decide the unlocked consequence before implementing it.

• Test the complete locked and unlocked responses and repeatable reset before adding a figure, headlights or more ambient variation.

Change record — Version 0.4 replaces one bundle with three scattered logs and one delivery. Version 0.3 established campsite routines and proposed encounter authoring, keeping the unlocked consequence open. Version 0.2 confirmed Quinn; version 0.1 established the baseline.